



equities, showing diversification at play rather than a complete abandonment of traditional savings instruments. Women are, in fact, flipping the financial script.

“This shift reflects growing financial awareness, access to digital platforms, and a stronger desire for financial independence,” says AnooShka Soham Bathwal, founder and CEO of Dhanvestor, a women-centric wealth manager.

Essentially, more women investors are seeking inflation-beating returns and long-term growth instead of short-term security. Their choices are now being guided by informed analysis, not convention, signalling a more empowered and confident generation of wealth creators.

“Women’s education and their own earning capacity have given them the confidence to make their own investment decisions,” says Renu Maheshwari, co-founder and Principal Advisor, Finscholarz Wealth Managers.

And the modern woman is investing not just for her family’s future, but to realise her own dreams.

“We see women planning for travel, solo trips, early retirement and entrepreneurship. We are seeing a shift through these goals from duty to self-prioritisation,” says Menezes.

WOMEN IN CHARGE

Financial literacy has become the foundation for women’s financial independence. Understanding key concepts such as compounding, asset allocation and inflation enables them to make informed decisions that align with personal milestones—from higher education and entrepreneurship to retirement planning.

On the social front, traditional gender roles are evolving, with women now making independent investment decisions for their households.

“This social shift, in part, reflects the influence of younger, more financially aware generations and a growing realisation that women need to secure their own financial future,” says Vidhi Tuteja, co-founder of ZFunds, a mutual funds platform.

Accessibility and information have played a huge role here. “Fintech has facilitated both, and women are embracing this change. Women are also emulating and challenging men in various fields, and investments are no different,” says Shweta Jain, founder of wealth management firm Investography.

A study by Axis Mutual Fund reveals that nearly 72% of women now make autonomous investment decisions, marking a pivotal shift from historical dependence on husbands and other male relatives or advisors.

Bengaluru-based Bharati Sudhir, 51, believes that in-

Why Women Are Leading the Change

- 1 **Taking charge of their financial future instead of relying on others**
- 2 **Knowledge of compounding, asset allocation, and inflation driving smarter choices**
- 3 **Accessible platforms boost confidence and broaden investing opportunities**
- 4 **Aligning investments with life goals—retirement, travel, entrepreneurship**

Smart Investing

33%

RISE IN EQUITY PARTICIPATION
BY WOMEN IN 2023

₹11.25

LAKH CRORE: MF AUM HELD BY WOMEN IN
2024, FROM ₹4.59 LAKH CRORE IN 2019

76%

OF WOMEN INVESTORS NOW
HOLD EQUITIES

vestment has taught her some great life lessons.

“On the market front, I have realised all that shines is not gold. One should do own thorough due diligence of the product and market trends and seek advice from trained professionals before putting down money,” says Sudhir.